

Delacroix

The leading Romantic painter in France, Eugène Delacroix (1798–1863) was admired by his contemporaries and also influenced the development of Impressionism, Post-Impressionism and Symbolism. Like Géricault, he was trained by Guérin, but he developed a personal, emotional style and palette through studying Rubens and 16th-century Venetian painters in the Louvre. Opposing the exactitude of Neoclassicism, he advocated spontaneity in painting, maintaining that colour and passion were more important than meticulous drawing.

In 1824, he won a gold medal at the prestigious Paris Salon. The following year he stayed in England, while later visits to Spain, Morocco and Algeria inspired richer colours, and more dynamic brushwork and compositions. His subjects included historical and contemporary events and literature, and his output in painting, printmaking and writing was vast. Through intense rivalry, Ingres delayed his election to the Institut of France, but in 1857 he was admitted, and also began teaching at the École des Beaux-Arts.



Delacroix, *Liberty Leading the People*, 1830